INTERVIEWER: I know that there are different ways to gauge profitability, but it seems they're [credit card banks] doing quite well.

EDWARD YINGLING: They're doing quite well; I would agree with that.

INTERVIEWER: Citibank is more profitable than Microsoft, Wal-Mart, and the executives are highly paid.

EDWARD YINGLING: Right, right.

In the beginning of the interview, Yingling was asked to describe the benefits of credit cards. He talked for a couple of paragraphs about how much his industry has done for the consumer. His conclusion – "When you think about it, it's really an incredible system...."

If you are interested in reading the complete interview, you can go to: http://www.pbs.org/wgbh/pages/frontline/shows/credit/interviews/yingling.html.

Trained Animal Acts

It is not just the credit card companies who like to play games with your money. Lending a helping hand is no longer the motto of the money lending industry. Car dealers, bankers, and anyone who is in the position of making some money off a person by giving them a finance deal, all have been known to take advantage of their trusting consumers. The temptation to pocket a little more if they can is too strong and the unwitting customer makes it too easy. Bankers, automobile finance departments, almost any kind of lender – they all try to present the image that they are your friends, the ones that you can turn to when you need financial help. All too often, their so-called "help" gets the trusting customer into deeper debt and deeper trouble.

Anthony had a mortgage on his current house for $200,000. He had a buyer and a contract for the sale of this house. Anthony found another house to buy in the country, with a little land and room for horses. Before the first sale was complete, the banker gave Anthony a new mortgage, another $200,000, on the new property. The pending sales contracts for both properties were being handled "for sale by owner," with no realtor involved.